

Daily Content Intel

August 11, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, the hamstring conversation always lands on Nordic curls, and Nordics are great, and I program them. Sprinting is the bigger lever.

There's a narrative review in the journal Sports where the whole argument sits right in the title. If you want to prevent hamstring injuries, run fast.

Here's the mechanism. When you go from 80 percent of your top speed up to 100 percent, the long head of the biceps femoris fires 67 percent harder through the terminal swing phase, that split second before the foot hits the ground. The other two hamstrings only climb 37 percent.

So the muscle that tears the most is the one that only gets fully loaded at true top speed.

Which means if your athlete never gets above 95 percent of their max in practice, that tissue never sees the demand, and then week one of the season asks for it anyway, at full speed, with a defender closing.

The programming piece from that review: 35 to 40 percent of sprint volume above 85 percent of max speed, and 15 to 20 percent above 95 percent. Introduce it progressively from preseason so you avoid spikes.

And a separate study on elite football turnarounds found that when the near-max exposure landed 2 days before the game, there were zero match hamstring injuries.

Go fast on purpose.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: If your athlete hasn't touched top speed since June, their hamstrings are the problem.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, the hamstring conversation always lands on Nordic curls, and Nordics are great, and I program them. Sprinting is the bigger lever.

There's a narrative review in the journal Sports where the whole argument sits right in the title. If you want to prevent hamstring injuries, run fast.

Here's the mechanism. When you go from 80 percent of your top speed up to 100 percent, the long head of the biceps femoris fires 67 percent harder through the terminal swing phase, that split second before the foot hits the ground. The other two hamstrings only climb 37 percent.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Your hamstring plan is missing sprinting
- 0:08 Nordics are good. Top speed is better.
- 0:18 80% → 100% speed = biceps femoris fires 67% harder

- 0:30 The tissue only gets loaded at true top speed
- 0:45 35-40% of sprint volume above 85% max speed
- 0:55 15-20% above 95%
- 1:05 Time it 2 days out from the game
- 1:15 Go fast on purpose

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The hamstring is the most re-injured muscle in field sport, and the fix most high school programs are missing is speed exposure.

The long head of the biceps femoris fires 67% harder at 100% of max speed than it does at 80%. The other hamstrings barely move. So if your athlete lives at 85% all summer, the exact tissue that tears never gets trained at the intensity that tears it.

Then camp opens and the season asks for 100% on day 3.

The review's numbers: 35-40% of weekly sprint volume above 85% of max speed, 15-20% above 95%. Build it progressively from preseason. A separate study on elite

football found the near-max exposure landed best 2 days before the game.

Football and lacrosse guys, this is your July and your Tuesday, both.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT

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#hamstring #speedtraining #footballtraining

#lacrosse #strengthandconditioning

#sportsPT #returntosport

#athletedevelopment #highschoolfootball

#injuryprevention

Personalize this

- Which of your football or lacrosse athletes actually hit 95% of max velocity in a normal training week, and how do you know it (timing gates, GPS, or eyeball)? Name the gap you see between what the offseason program prescribes and what the sport coach's practice actually delivers.
- Have you had a hamstring re-injury come back through your table where the athlete had done all the Nordics and none of the

sprinting? That case is the whole Reel.

- Where does max-velocity work sit in the weekly template you build for HS football, and does the 2-days-out finding match or contradict how you've been placing it? Say it out loud either way.

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11126098/> | "If You Want to Prevent Hamstring Injuries in Soccer, Run Fast: A Narrative Review about Practical Considerations of Sprint Training"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11126098/> | "Specifically, as running speed increased from 80% to 100%, the BFIh activity during the terminal swing phase increased by an average of 67%, while the semitendinosus and the semimembranosus only showed a 37% increase."
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11126098/> | "It should also be noted that, during our weekly microcycle, we try to ensure that of all the sprints covered and measured in an absolute

way, 35–40% of their total volume should exceed 85% of the MSS and 15–20% exceed 95%."

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11126098/>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10588569/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. I listened to a Flex Diet episode with Dr. Emily Werner, she's the team dietitian for the 76ers, and the line that stuck with me was pro athletes chasing 200,000 dollar wellness gadgets while the basics sit there untouched.

Same thing happens at the high school level, it's just cheaper. Creatine, a pre-workout, two recovery powders, and a kid who ate a granola bar at 7am and nothing else until 8pm after practice.

Here's what that actually costs you. There's a narrative review on low energy availability, and when energy availability drops to 25 calories per kilo of fat-free mass per day, resting metabolic rate falls and T3, that's a thyroid hormone, drops right along with it.

That's the body turning off the lights to save power. Growth, repair, and adaptation all get dimmed.

One study inside that review had 55 percent of athletes screening positive for low energy availability, and in male cyclists who had it, 44 percent showed lumbar spine bone density Z-scores below negative one. That happens quietly, and you tend to find out mid-season.

So fix the floor first. Breakfast, a real lunch, food inside an hour after training, and something before bed.

The supplements are fine, they just work on top of an athlete who's actually fed.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: The most underrated supplement for your high school athlete is lunch.

Spoken script (word for word):

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Same thing happens at the high school level, it's just cheaper. Creatine, a pre-workout, two recovery powders, and a kid who ate a granola bar at 7am and nothing else until 8pm after practice.

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44 percent showed lumbar spine bone density Z-scores below negative one. That happens quietly, and you tend to find out mid-season.

So fix the floor first. Breakfast, a real lunch, food inside an hour after training, and something before bed.

The supplements are fine, they just work on top of an athlete who's actually fed.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 The most underrated supplement is lunch
- 0:10 Pro athletes buy \$200K gadgets. HS athletes buy powders.
- 0:22 Granola bar at 7am, nothing until 8pm
- 0:35 EA drops to 25 kcal/kg FFM → RMR and T3 fall
- 0:48 55% screened positive for low energy availability
- 0:58 44% of male cyclists with LEA: lumbar Z-score < -1

- 1:08 Breakfast. Lunch. Post-training. Before bed.
- 1:18 Supplements work on top of a fed athlete

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A team dietitian for an NBA franchise says the hardest part of her job is getting athletes to stop chasing \$200K wellness gadgets and eat.

The high school version costs less and does the same damage. Creatine, a pre-workout, two recovery powders, and a granola bar at 7am with nothing until 8pm.

When energy availability falls to 25 kcal per kg of fat-free mass per day, resting metabolic rate drops and T3 drops with it. The body dims growth, repair, and adaptation to protect itself. One study inside a recent review had 55% of athletes screening positive for low energy availability, and 44% of male cyclists with it had lumbar spine bone density Z-scores under negative one.

Your athlete is under-fueled before they're under-supplemented.

Fix the floor: breakfast, a real lunch, food within an hour of training, something before bed. Then the stack has something to work on top of.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT

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#sportsnutrition #fuelingforperformance

#highschoolathlete #REDS

#athletedevelopment #footballtraining

#lacrosse #strengthandconditioning

#sportsPT #recovery

Personalize this

- Name a specific athlete you've worked with whose "recovery problem" or nagging soreness turned out to be a fueling problem. What did their actual day of eating look like when you finally asked?
- What's the fueling question you now ask in an intake or a screen with a HS football or lacrosse athlete, and how do you get an honest answer out of a 16-year-old? Give the exact wording you use.

- How does this map onto CROSS and the Threshold positioning: where does fueling sit relative to the training and rehab work you sell, and what do you tell parents who show up with a supplement list before a food list?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/urolithin-a-mitochondrial-health-and-nutrition-for-pro-athletes-dr-emily-werner> | "Urolithin A, Mitochondrial Health, and Nutrition for Pro Athletes"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12849792/> | "significant decrease in resting metabolic rate and T3 concentration was observed when EA was reduced to 25 kcal/kg FFM/day"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12849792/> | "In athletes without amenorrhoea but with positive screening for LEA, proactive education, surveillance, and intervention should be considered before bone density begins to decline."

Sources:

- <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/urolithin-a-mitochondrial-health-and-nutrition-for-pro-athletes-dr-emily-werner>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12849792/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Buchheit's turnaround data on its own: a whole Reel on where in the week max-velocity work belongs for a Friday-night football schedule (PMC10588569, unused screenshot targets available).
- Urolithin A / postbiotics as a standalone "is this worth it for a HS athlete" myth-check, once a fetchable primary trial is located (MDPI paywalls blocked today's attempt).
- Adolescent ACL prevention: the SportsMed summer 2026 framework piece on neuromuscular training program adherence in HS athletes.

Sources scanned today

- **Newsletter digest**
newsletter_digest_2026-08-11.pdf, 2 sources. Dr. Mercola (pure supplement promo, skipped). Mike T. Nelson Flex Diet Podcast Ep. 399 with Dr. Emily Werner (team dietitian, Philadelphia 76ers):

postbiotics, urolithin A, athletes chasing expensive wellness gadgets, chronic under-fueling, "nutrition's real job: keeping athletes available to play." Used for Draft B.

- **PubMed / PMC:** swept sprint training, hamstring injury prevention, high-speed running exposure, adolescent resistance training, ACL return-to-sport, low energy availability in youth athletes. Best athlete-actionable hit: Gómez-Piqueras & Alcaraz narrative review in *Sports* (2024) on sprint exposure as hamstring prevention. Second confirming source: Buchheit et al., *Biology of Sport* (2023) on day-of-week timing of near-maximal speed exposure.
- **MDPI direct:** *Applied Sciences* sprint/hamstring scoping review (15/16/9003) and *Nutrients* "Fueling the Future" (18/14/2327) both returned HTTP 403 on fetch. Could not verify verbatim text, so neither was cited. Substituted fetchable PMC equivalents.
- **BJSM / JOSPT / Sports Health:** no new athlete-relevant item in the last 7 days

surfaced above what PubMed already returned.

- **NSCA / Pacey Performance / Just Fly / Iron Culture:** nothing fresher than the sprint-exposure thread already covered.
- **Low energy availability:** Konvicka et al., *Physiological Research* (2025) narrative review on LEA, bone health, and metabolism. Used for Draft B.
- **Dedup:** cited-sources.json read (130 entries). PMC11126098, PMC10588569, PMC12849792, and the Ep. 399 URL are all absent. Note: PMC12644382 (AFL running load / hamstring cohort) was rejected, already cited 2026-08-10.